

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Importing is modelled as: Source compliant goods with landed-cost margin.

Typical starting capital band: 2000-50000. Expected time to first income or result: 45-240 days.

Risk: Very high. Complexity: Very high. These are broad planning bands, not probabilities or guarantees.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Best suited to someone able to serve or access: Local retailers, businesses or consumers.

Core capabilities: Customs and compliance; Landed-cost modelling; Supplier and buyer verification.

Avoid or delay this route when essential bills, legal requirements, debt service, safety, liquidity or family commitments cannot be protected.

HOW MONEY IS GENERATED

Source compliant goods with landed-cost margin

The paying counterparty or economic source is: Local retailers, businesses or consumers.

Profit or retained value exists only after variable costs, fixed costs, tax, financing, returns, failures and owner labour are counted.

STARTING REQUIREMENTS

Capital: 2000-50000.

Skills: Customs and compliance; Landed-cost modelling; Supplier and buyer verification.

Tools: Landed-cost calculator; Incoterms checklist; Supplier due diligence; Currency risk sheet.

Verify registrations, licences, insurance, consumer rules, data protection, tax and sector-specific restrictions before trading or investing.

ILLUSTRATIVE UNIT ECONOMICS

Illustrative price or monthly value per unit: EUR 70.

Illustrative variable cost per unit: EUR 42.

Illustrative monthly fixed cost: EUR 2500.

Illustrative monthly volume: 500.

Illustrative monthly revenue: EUR 35000; contribution before fixed costs: EUR 14000; operating surplus before tax and owner labour: EUR 11500.

Illustrative break-even volume: 90 units per month.

All figures are assumptions for planning. Replace them with verified local quotes and conservative scenarios.

FIRST 24 HOURS

Choose one product and destination market.

Check tariff, restriction and standards requirements.

Calculate full landed cost.

FIRST SEVEN DAYS

Verify two suppliers and ten buyers.

Order samples only.

Agree specifications, Incoterms and payment protection.

FIRST 30 DAYS

Complete a small compliant shipment or test order.

Record delays, damage and true margin.

Build alternative supplier and freight routes.

FIRST 90 DAYS

Negotiate repeat orders and currency rules.

Expand only after compliance and cash cycle are proven.

FIRST YEAR ROADMAP

Quarter 1: prove demand, suitability or operational feasibility with the smallest responsible test.

Quarter 2: improve unit economics, documentation, compliance and repeatability.

Quarter 3: reduce concentration, strengthen reserves and build a second acquisition or distribution route.

Quarter 4: complete a full profit, cash-flow, tax, risk and continuation review before scaling.

CUSTOMER OR CAPITAL ACQUISITION

Secure a reliable supplier and a real buyer route before committing large inventory. Use trade fairs, chambers, distributors and direct B2B sales.

Record outreach volume, response, conversion, acquisition cost, retention and cash collection. For investments, record contribution, fees, allocation and reason for

ownership instead.

TOOLS AND TEMPLATES

Landed-cost calculator

Incoterms checklist

Supplier due diligence

Currency risk sheet

Budget and cash-flow tracker

Pricing or suitability calculator

Break-even or loss-capacity calculation

Weekly scorecard

Risk register

90-day action plan

FAILURE ANALYSIS

Risk: Ignoring duty and VAT. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.

Risk: Counterfeit or unsafe goods. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.

Risk: Currency and shipping shocks. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.

Risk: Weak contracts. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.

DECISION TEST

START NOW only when the smallest safe test is affordable and lawful.

LEARN FIRST when the model is understood but the required skill, evidence or compliance is missing.

TEST CHEAPLY when demand or suitability is uncertain.

AVOID when loss could threaten housing, health, tax compliance or essential obligations.

SEEK PROFESSIONAL ADVICE for contracts, tax, regulated investments, property, borrowing, employment law or complex entities.

PRIMARY RESEARCH ROUTES

EU Access2Markets: <https://trade.ec.europa.eu/access-to-markets/>

French Customs: <https://www.douane.gouv.fr/>

EVIDENCE AND LEGAL BOUNDARY

This material is educational and based on public information. It is not personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice.

Costs, taxes, laws, returns and risks vary by location and personal circumstances.

Verify current rules and consult an appropriately qualified professional before committing significant money or signing contracts.

No guaranteed returns, fake case studies, hidden ownership, tax evasion, borrowed-money speculation or unsupported income claims are permitted.